MIL-F-36608A
14 April 1972
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-36608
7 October 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FORCEPS, TOWEL, NONPERFORATING

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of nonperforating towel forceps for affixing towels to skin surfaces during surgical procedures.

1.2 Classification. The towel forceps shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.3):

Size 1 - 3-3/4 inch length
Size 1 - 5-1/4 inch length

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

GG-I-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
MMM-A-250	Adhesive, Water Resistant, (for sealing fiberboard boxes).
PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-76	Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive Paper, (for carton sealing).

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of.

FSC 6515

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STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attrubutes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General Requirements. The towel forceps shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526, and the following option exercises under that specification.

3.2 Material. The towel forceps shall be fabricated from Class 4, Type 410 or Type 420 material.

3.3 Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the Rockwell hardness of the towel forceps shall be C40 to C45.

3.4 Style, design, and dimensions. The style, design, and dimensions of the towel forceps shall be in accordance with Figure 1. The towel forceps shall have nonperforating teeth, suitable for affixing towels to skin surfaces during surgical procedures.

3.5 Construction.

3.5.1 Teeth. Shall be in accordance with GG-I-526. Teeth shall be 7 x 8 or 8 x 9 and shall be designed to grip firmly without puncturing cloth and tissue. When tested as specified in 4.4.1, the teeth shall grip the test material firmly and securely without puncturing or tearing it. The forceps shall not be capable of releasing the test material with the jaws clamped in the tightest ratchet position.

3.5.2 Locks. Shall be box lock type.

3.6 Finish. Shall be mirror finish.

3.7 Identification Marking. In addition to GG-I-526 requirements, towel forceps of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwide specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

* 4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion resisting steel may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the FSN, the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels shall be as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps.

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Table I. Sampling for Examination

Type of Defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	4.0

* 4.2.2 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table II. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps.

Table II. Sampling for Tests

Component (unit of product)	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Entire Forceps	Composition analysis	3.2 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	**	*
Entire Forceps	Hardness	3.3 and GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	*
Entire Forceps	Dimensions	3.4	----	S-2	*
Entire Forceps	Teeth performance	3.5.1	4.4.1	S-2	*
Entire Forceps	Copper sulfate	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	*
Entire Forceps	Boil test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	*
Entire Forceps	Distortion	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-3	*
Entire Forceps	Lock stiffness	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-3	4.0

* Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.
** Sufficient amount from each lot of each metal used in the construction of the towel forceps shall be selected for composition analysis.

4.3 Examination. The towel forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with specification requirements. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and the following classification of defects. Examination shall include, but shall not be limited to the defects listed in Table III.

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Table III. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Style and design not as specified.
102	Instrument not constructed as specified.
103	Instrument not free from sharp edges, rough areas, burrs, cracks, grind marks, or overlaps.
104	Teeth do not mesh accurately.
105	Teeth not of uniform size and depth.
106	Locks not accurately fitted or pins not permanently secured.
Minor	
201	Finish not as specified.
202	Instrument not permanently and legibly marked with either the name or trademark of the contractor.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Teeth performance test. The test material shall be rubber dam meeting the requirements for Federal Stock Number 6520-754-2769, RUBBER DAM, Medium, 6 inches square, 36s. The jaws of the forceps shall be clamped in the tightest ratchet position on one layer of the test material. Three separate, consecutive tests shall be performed for each forceps.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table IV shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

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Table IV. Packaging Quantities

Size	Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1	1 unit	12 units	192 units
2	1 unit	12 units	144 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units may be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Cleaning and drying. Each unit shall be thoroughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable method as outlined in MIL-P-116.

5.1.3.2 Preservation. Not required.

5.1.3.3 Intimate wrap. Each unit shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive materials.

5.1.3.4 Unit package. Each unit shall be package in accordance with MIL-P-116, method 1C-1.

5.1.3.5 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant. Boxes shall be closed by taping the top and bottom flaps with 2 inch wide tape conforming to PPP-T-76. Closing of bottom flaps with adhesive conforming to MMM-A-250 or metal stitches is permitted.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

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5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The towel forceps are intended for affixing towels to skin surfaces during surgical procedures.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and the procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Sizes required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1).
(d) Federal stock number.

6.3 Federal Stock No. (FSN) coverage. This specification is intended to cover the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog.

Federal Stock No.	Item Identification	Size
6515-442-6882	Forceps, Towel, Nonperforating, 3-3/4 inch	1
6515-442-6883	Forceps, Towel, Nonperforating, 5-1/4 inch	2

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6.4 This specification does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

6.5 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the previous issue.

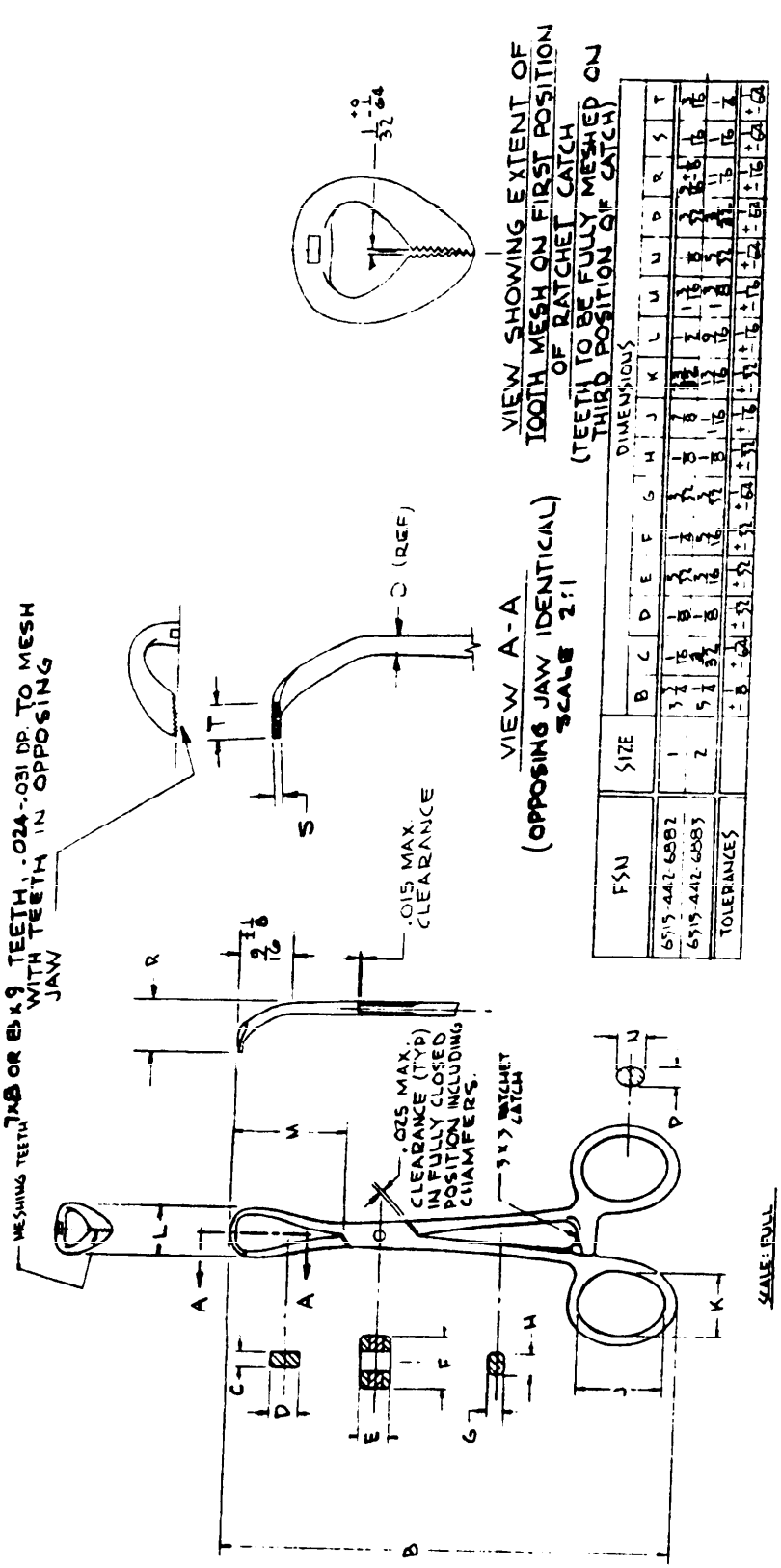
Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing acitivity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM
Project No. 6515-1637

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

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FSN	SIZE	DIMENSIONS																
		B	C	D	E	F	G	H	J	K	L	M	N	P	R	S	T
6515-447-6882	1	1 1/2	15/16	1/8	1/8	3/32	1/8	3/16	1/2	1/2	1/2	1	1/2	1/2	1 3/8	1/16	1/16
6515-447-6883	2	1 1/2	1 1/16	1/8	1/8	3/32	1/8	3/16	1/2	1/2	1/2	1	1/2	1/2	1 3/8	1/16	1/16
TOLERANCES		±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01	±.01

GENERAL NOTES:

1. TOLERANCES INDICATED DELINEATE ACCEPTABLE PATTERN DIMENSIONS AND ARE NOT INTENDED TO ENSURE VARIATIONS WITHIN A SINGLE ASSEMBLY WITH A SPECIFIC UNIFORMITY. SYMMETRY AND FIRST QUALITY WORKMANSHIP.
2. REMOVE BURRS AND BREAK SHARP EDGES.

FIGURE 1

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document (s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION
MIL-F-36608A

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

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